Claude Code mods: panes, watchers, dashboards and unfinished work

What to choose

A mod changes Claude Code behavior or its terminal UI; a skill supplies instructions. The five sources cover visual customization, a Duckboard-style multi-session dashboard, a "Left undone" panel, and a background watcher. These are complementary views of one extensibility workflow, not five separate installations.

The current official overview (https://code.claude.com/docs/en/plugins/mods/overview) documents JavaScript/TypeScript event handlers inside plugins. Validate a chosen plugin before loading it. A pane does not establish a cross-session datastore, and a skipped-task detector cannot prove that tests passed. Use real test results as evidence.

One supported starting path

These are documentation-based setup instructions, not commands executed for this guide:

```
claude --version
git clone https://github.com/anthropics/claude-code-playground.git
cd claude-code-playground/claude-code/mods
claude plugin validate ./blast-radius
claude --plugin-dir ./blast-radius
```

The examples are reference plugins, not production guarantees. Inspect their files and adapt to the installed release. The playground (https://github.com/anthropics/claude-code-playground/tree/main/claude-code/mods) includes Blast Radius and Replay Theater. The plugin documentation (https://code.claude.com/docs/en/plugins) explains manifests, marketplaces and local loading.

Current correction to the watcher reel

The official overview now lists `cc-plugin-you-should-know` as an available built-in side agent, disabled by default where offered. Inspect `/plugin` -> Installed -> Show disabled before enabling it. Availability for a particular account is still an account check. Earlier source guides that described its identity as unverified are retained as dated evidence; this correction takes precedence.

Distinct additions from the other demonstrations

- Filetree and skins customize navigation/appearance. Community repositories remain separate from Anthropic's supported samples: filetree (https://github.com/data-goblin/claude-code-filetree), skins (https://github.com/hellosverre/claude-skins), and Reflect (https://github.com/BayramAnnakov/claude-reflect).
- Duckboard describes aggregating several sessions. Begin with per-session events, then define an explicit local transport, timestamps, stale-session expiry and a read-only aggregator. A single-session render hook alone cannot provide this.

- Left Undone describes a task ledger. Track declared tasks, evidence of execution and unresolved items separately. TODO text is a hint, not proof of a missed requirement.
- Cache Tax measures caching costs; its economics belong in the separate caching guide. A UI display does not make repeated requests free.

Project and reusable brief

Build a local session ledger first: record tool counts and explicit task states for one session, render a small pane, then add a second session through a documented adapter. Test session expiry, malformed events and reconnects. Do not auto-approve commands or infer success from reassuring prose.

```
Using the current official mod contract, implement a read-only session ledger.
Start with one local plugin and fixture events. Show task state with evidence
links, mark uncertain tasks explicitly, and keep all network access off by
default. Add a dashboard only after testing the single-session adapter.
Deliver setup, tests, permission notes and a reproducible demonstration.
```

All original source URLs, transcripts, community links and individual PDFs remain in Sources and Files. Their dated implementation details may differ; this unified guide is the preferred entry point.

Original sources

- https://youtu.be/lDrAZ1wAyVs
- https://youtu.be/ERNqRK6sMJY
- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DeCu7c8BZmd/
- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DeJhQj8hkGy/
- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DeRQMvaBZY4/